

Determinant of 2×2 matrices

Basic skills

Q1. a) $\begin{vmatrix} 5 & 3 \\ 1 & 2 \end{vmatrix} = 5 \times 2 - 3 \times 1 = 10 - 3 = 7$

Diagram: A green circle highlights the elements 5, 3, 1, and 2. A green arrow labeled 'trail' points from 5 to 2, and another green arrow labeled 'lead' points from 3 to 1.

b) $\begin{vmatrix} -3 & -1 \\ 2 & 1 \end{vmatrix} = -3 \times 1 - (-1 \times 2) = -3 + 2 = -1$

c) $\begin{vmatrix} 4 & 2 \\ -2 & 4 \end{vmatrix} = 4 \times 4 - 2 \times -2 = 16 + 4 = 20$

Q2. As area SF is $|M|$ its $8 \times |M|$

$|M| = \begin{vmatrix} 3 & 1 \\ 4 & 2 \end{vmatrix} = 6 - 4 = 2$ so new area $8 \times 2 = 16$

Q3. As reflection preserves area so determinant must be 1.

Q4. To preserve area $|M| = 1$

$\Rightarrow \begin{vmatrix} a & 0 \\ 0 & a \end{vmatrix} = 1 \Rightarrow ad - 0 = 1 \Rightarrow a = \frac{1}{a}$

Q5. $|M| = 5$

$$\Rightarrow \begin{vmatrix} x & -3 \\ 3 & x-5 \end{vmatrix} = 5 \Rightarrow x(x-5) + 9 = 5$$

$$\Rightarrow x^2 - 5x + 4 = 0 \Rightarrow (x-4)(x-1) = 0$$

so $x = 1$ or 4

Q6. $\begin{vmatrix} x & y \\ 5 & 1 \end{vmatrix} = 2 \Rightarrow x - 5y = 2$

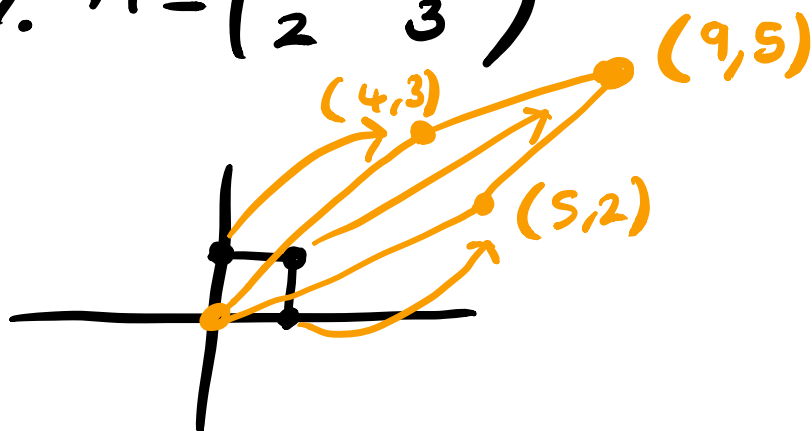
$$\begin{vmatrix} x & 2 \\ y & 3 \end{vmatrix} = 5 \Rightarrow 3x - 2y = 5$$

so $\begin{aligned} -3x - 15y &= 6 \\ 3x - 2y &= 5 \end{aligned} \Rightarrow -13y = 1 \quad y = -\frac{1}{13}$

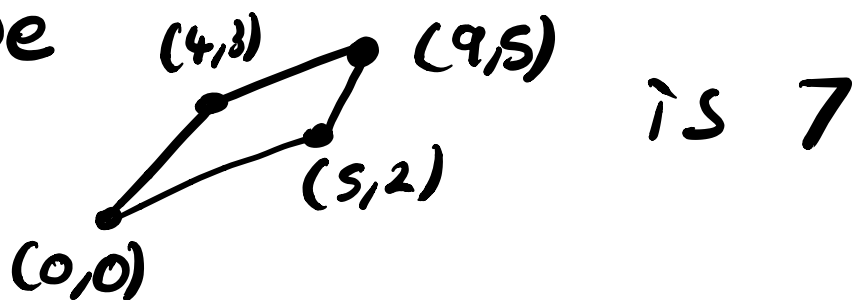
and $x = 2 + 5y = 2 - \frac{5}{13}$ so $x = \frac{21}{13}$

Q7. $M = \begin{pmatrix} 5 & 4 \\ 2 & 3 \end{pmatrix}$

a)



b) $|M| = 15 - 8 = 7$ so new area of shape



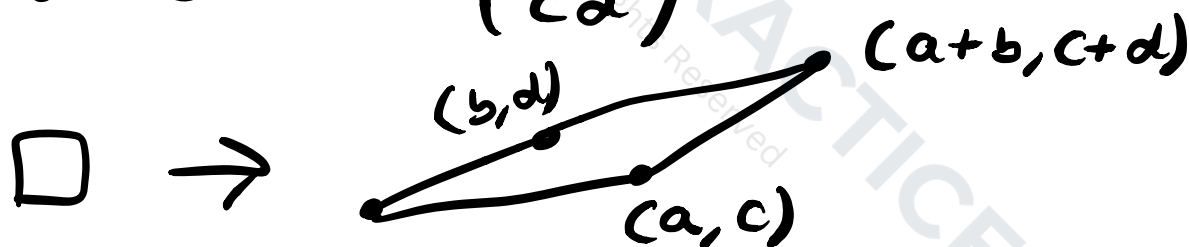
Q8. Let $M = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \Rightarrow kM = \begin{pmatrix} ka & kb \\ kc & kd \end{pmatrix}$

$$\text{so } |kM| = \begin{vmatrix} ka & kb \\ kc & kd \end{vmatrix} = ka \times kd - kb \times kc$$

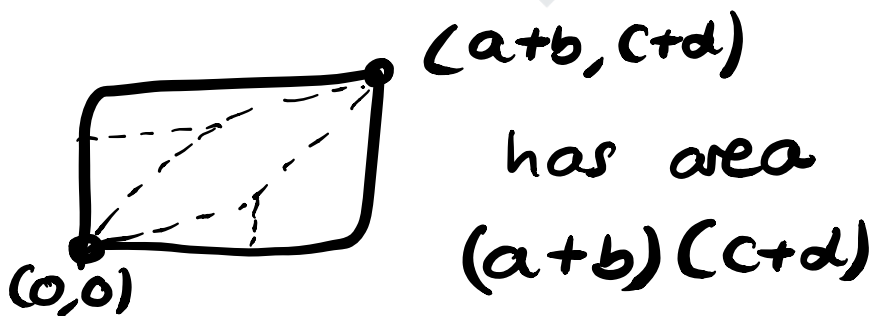
$$= k^2 ad - k^2 bc$$

$$= k^2 (ad - bc) = k^2 |M|$$

Q9. under $M = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}$



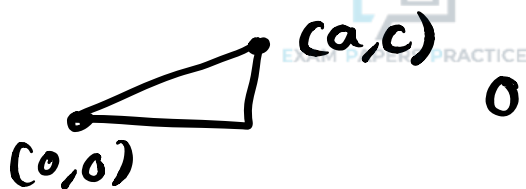
now full rect



now remove

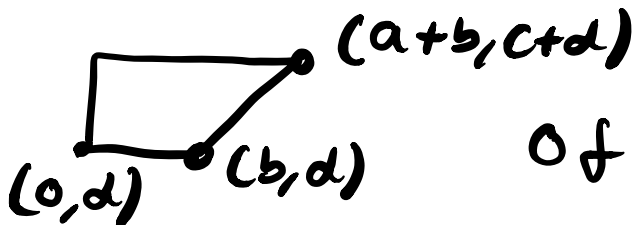


and remove



of area $\frac{1}{2}ac$

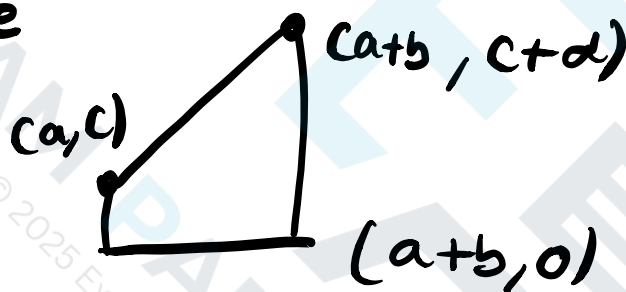
and remove



of area

$$\frac{1}{2}(b+a+b) \times c \\ = (b + \frac{1}{2}a)c$$

and remove



of area

$$\frac{1}{2}(c+c+d) \times b \\ = (c + \frac{1}{2}d)b$$

$$\text{SO } (a+b)(c+d) - \frac{1}{2}bd - \frac{1}{2}ac \\ - (b + \frac{1}{2}a)c - (c + \frac{1}{2}d)b$$

$$= \cancel{ac} + bc + ad + \cancel{bd} - \cancel{bd} - \cancel{dc} - 2bc$$

$$= ad - bc$$

as required

$$\text{as } \begin{vmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{vmatrix} = ad - bc$$

Q10. $y = x+1$ mapped to $(1,2)$

a) so for any x : $\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x \\ x+2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}$

$$\Rightarrow xa + xb + 2b = 1$$

$$xc + xd + 2d = 2$$

so let $a = -b$, $2b = 1$
 $c = -d$, $2d = 2$

$$\Rightarrow a = -\frac{1}{2}, b = \frac{1}{2}, c = -1, d = 1$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} -\frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} \\ -1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \text{ determinant } -\frac{1}{2} - -\frac{1}{2} = 0$$

b) $\begin{pmatrix} -\frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} \\ -1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{1}{2}x + \frac{1}{2}y \\ -x + y \end{pmatrix}$

so $x' = \frac{1}{2}(y-x)$, $y' = y-x$

so $y' = 2x'$ so all points mapped
 to $y = 2x$

c) Take line $y = mx + c$

$$\begin{pmatrix} -\frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} \\ -1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} x \\ mx + c \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

needs to be true for all x
↓

$$\Rightarrow -x + mx + c = 0 \Rightarrow (m-1)x + c = 0$$

so $m = 1$ and $c = 0$ so $y = x$ maps to $(0,0)$

Q11. Let $A = \begin{pmatrix} a_{11} & a_{12} \\ a_{21} & a_{22} \end{pmatrix}$ $B = \begin{pmatrix} b_{11} & b_{12} \\ b_{21} & b_{22} \end{pmatrix}$

$$a) AB = \begin{pmatrix} a_{11}b_{11} + a_{12}b_{21} & a_{11}b_{12} + a_{12}b_{22} \\ a_{21}b_{11} + a_{22}b_{21} & a_{21}b_{12} + a_{22}b_{22} \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \det(AB) &= (a_{11}b_{11} + a_{12}b_{21})(a_{21}b_{12} + a_{22}b_{22}) \\ &\quad - (a_{11}b_{12} + a_{12}b_{22})(a_{21}b_{11} + a_{22}b_{21}) \\ &= (a_{11}a_{22} - a_{12}a_{21})(b_{11}b_{22} - b_{12}b_{21}) \\ &= \det(A) \det(B) \end{aligned}$$

SO TRUE and proven

$$b) A+B = \begin{pmatrix} a_{11}+b_{11} & a_{12}+b_{12} \\ a_{21}+b_{21} & a_{22}+b_{22} \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \det(A+B) &= (a_{11}+b_{11})(a_{22}+b_{22}) \\ &\quad - (a_{12}+b_{12})(a_{21}+b_{21}) \\ &= (a_{11}a_{22} - a_{12}a_{21}) \\ &\quad + (b_{11}b_{22} - b_{12}b_{21}) \end{aligned} \quad \left. \begin{array}{l} \det(A) \\ + \det(B) \end{array} \right\}$$

$$+ a_{11}b_{22} + b_{11}a_{22} - a_{12}b_{21} - b_{12}a_{21}$$

$$\neq \det(A) + \det(B)$$

So False

Also a simple counter example

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad B = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 2 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\text{Then } \det(A+B) = \det \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 3 \\ 3 & 2 \end{pmatrix} = -5 \neq 0 + -3$$

$$\det(A) = 0 \quad \det(B) = -3$$